Mingming Li

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Research interests Gender inequality; STEM and educational stratification; work and labor markets.

EDUCATION

PhD candidate in Sociology, University of Innsbruck 09/2023–present
Dissertation Affluence and the gender gap in STEM study choices
Supervisor Wilfred Uunk. *Co-supervisor* Andreas Steinmayr.
Expected completion June 2027.

MPhil in Economics, Central European University 09/2018–12/2021
Research on wage inequality and decomposition methods in the labor market.

MA in International Economy and Business 09/2016–06/2018
Corvinus University of Budapest

Bachelor of Economics; Bachelor of Literature (dual degrees) 09/2012–06/2016
Wu Yuzhang Honors College, Sichuan University, Chengdu, China.
Majors in Economics and Journalism.

Exchange student, National Sun Yat-sen University 02/2015–07/2015
Department of Political Economy, Kaohsiung, Taiwan, China.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Visiting Scholar, LIfBi, Bamberg, Germany 10/2025–01/2026
Leibniz Institute for Educational Trajectories. Host: Corinna Kleinert. Research on affluence and gender gaps in STEM choices in Germany.

Zhejiang University, Hangzhou, China 09/2022–09/2023
Institute of Common Prosperity and Development. Supervised by Li Shi and Guo Jiqiang. Led research on wage collective bargaining in Deqing; contributed to the Huzhou Common Prosperity Blue Book.

Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest, Hungary 01/2021–12/2021
Human Capital Effects of Abortion Laws in Hungary (PI: Agnes Szabo). Policy analysis, model design, Stata programming, and manuscript writing.

RESEARCH FUNDING AND PROJECTS

Austrian Science Fund (FWF) research project 10/2023–09/2026
Research contribution to Affluence and the Gender Gap in STEM Study Choices.
PI: Wilfred Uunk. Grant P36789.

Principal Investigator, EPoS Young Scholar Research Funding (2026) 06/2026–06/2027
University of Innsbruck. Gendered Platform Work in China: Stigma, Algorithms, and Household Inequality.

Principal Investigator, EPoS Young Scholar Research Funding (2024) 06/2024–06/2025
University of Innsbruck. The Role of the Gig Economy in Gender Wage Gaps in China.

DOCTORAL DISSERTATION

Affluence and the gender gap in STEM study choices

This article-based dissertation examines how societal affluence, occupational opportunities, and household resources relate to gendered STEM aspirations, higher education entry, and graduation. Four studies use UNESCO, TIMSS, NEPS, and CFPS data, combining cross-national comparisons with evidence from Germany and China.

The findings distinguish general economic security, which is associated with wider STEM gender gaps, from STEM-specific rewards and accessibility, which are associated with narrower gaps. Household income in Germany and assets beyond housing in China also show contrasting associations with women's STEM entry.

Societal affluence and STEM graduation.
UNESCO panel data, 113 countries. Published in *Sex Roles (2026)*.

Occupational opportunities and STEM aspirations.
TIMSS. Under external review, *American Journal of Sociology*.

Household income and STEM choice.
NEPS, Germany. Under review after major revision, *Social Science Research*.

Assets beyond housing and STEM entry.
CFPS, China. Under external review, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.

JOURNAL ARTICLES AND MANUSCRIPTS

A complete list sorted by publication status is provided in the separate publication list.

* Corresponding author. † Dissertation article.

Gender, STEM, and Educational Stratification

† Wilfred Uunk and **Mingming Li***. 2026. "Does Societal Affluence Increase the Gender Gap in STEM Graduation? A Longitudinal Assessment." *Sex Roles* 92(3), 19. doi.org/10.1007/s11199-026-01654-1

Zheng Lu*, Wei Li, **Mingming Li**, and Yixuan Chen. 2019. "Destination China: International Students in Chengdu." *International Migration* 57(3), 354–372. doi.org/10.1111/imig.12464

† **Mingming Li***. "Household Income and Gendered STEM Choice: Evidence from Germany." Under review after major revision, *Social Science Research*.

† **Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. "Economic Opportunity and the Formation of Gendered STEM Aspirations: Security, Returns, and Accessibility." Under external review, *American Journal of Sociology*.

† **Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. "Assets beyond Housing and Gendered Entry into Science and Engineering among Homeowning Families in China." Under external review, *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.

Mingming Li* and Wilfred Uunk. "Gendered Entry, Convergent Exit: The Association of Occupational Interests and Labor Market Signals with STEM Educational Trajectories." Under external review, *European Sociological Review*.

Mingming Li* and Wilfred Uunk. "Gender and the Realisation of STEM Credentials in Urban China." Under review after major revision, *British Journal of Sociology of Education*.

Mingming Li*. "The gender-equality paradox in mathematics-related occupational aspirations varies by societal measure and geographic comparison." Under external review, *Psychological Science*.

Mingming Li and Maria Charles*. "From Housing Institutions to Gendered Fields of Study: The Educational Conversion of Institutional Advantage in Marketizing China." Work in progress.

Mingming Li*, Wilfred Uunk, and Pia Blossfeld. "The Rise of College–College Marriage in China: Educational Composition and Sorting by Own and Parental Education." Work in progress.

Lukas Arnold, Lukas Engelberger, Jonas Kamp, Liron Kol, Laura-Sophia Koller, **Mingming Li***, and Wilfred Uunk*. "Higher Education Lowers Science Skepticism, but Not When Status Is Inconsistent." Work in progress.

Gender, Work, and Labor Markets

Mingming Li*, Xinyun Hu, Keyan Jin, and Jiachen Han. 2025. “Exploring factors influencing entry into the gig economy: A study of Chinese workers.” *Acta Psychologica* 259, 105301. doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.105301

Mingming Li*, Xinyun Hu, and Keyan Jin. 2025. “The Return on Education and the Gender Wage Gap in China: A Sector Perspective.” *SAGE Open* 15(2), 21582440251327015. doi.org/10.1177/21582440251327015

Jiachen Han, **Mingming Li***, Shi Li, and Yingying Hu. 2024. “The widening gender wage gap in the gig economy in China: the impact of digitalisation.” *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* 11(1), 1639. doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-04172-1

Mingming Li*, Yuan Tang, and Keyan Jin. 2024. “Labor market segmentation and the gender wage gap: Evidence from China.” *PLOS ONE* 19(3), e0299355. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0299355

Mingming Li* and Fumei Zhang. 2023. “The wage structure and gap between public and private sectors: an empirical study in urban China.” *Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja* 36(2), 2106276. doi.org/10.1080/1331677x.2022.2106276

Mingming Li*, Chunlu Tu, and Fumei Zhang. 2022. “Wage Gaps in Energy Industry: The Role of Sector.” *Frontiers in Energy Research* 10, 940637. doi.org/10.3389/fenrg.2022.940637

Mingming Li* and Jiayun Wang. 2021. “Influence of UTCP on the employment of female workers and the supply of labor force.” *PLOS ONE* 16(11), e0259843. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0259843

Tianhe Chen and **Mingming Li***. “Algorithmic Benevolent Sexism: Female Ride-Hailing Drivers and the Paradox of Platform Protection in China.” Under review after minor revision, *Sex Roles*.

Tianhe Chen and **Mingming Li***. “Algorithmic Collaboration and Negotiated Dependence: Gendered Claim-Making and Platform Governance in China’s Ride-Hailing Sector.” Under review, *New Technology, Work and Employment*.

Xinyi Wei, Ru Jia, and **Mingming Li***. “Platform Access and Conditional Occupational Membership among Women Ride-Hailing Drivers in China.” Under external review, *Work, Employment and Society*.

Mingming Li* and Xinxin Ma. “Who Holds the Protected Job? Labor Contracts and the Gendered Division of Earnings within Chinese Couples.” Under review, *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*.

Mingming Li and Xinxin Ma*. “Gender wage gaps across the social insurance divide: Distributional evidence from China.” With editor, *Labour Economics*.

Energy, Environment, and Development

Chengying Yang, **Mingming Li***, and Dianyi Zhou. 2024. “Energy assessment in rural regions of China with various scenarios: Historical–to–futuristic.” *Energy* 302, 131894. doi.org/10.1016/j.energy.2024.131894

Mingming Li, Marko Milojevic, and Dmitry Gura*. 2024. “Development of methodology for evaluating sustainable rural development.” *Environment, Development and Sustainability* 26(8), 21237–21257. doi.org/10.1007/s10668-023-03526-0

Xinyun Hu, Yanling Jiang, Pengfei Guo*, and **Mingming Li**. 2024. “How does China's big data policy affect the digital economy of cities? Evidence from national big data comprehensive pilot zones.” *Heliyon* 10(2), e24638. doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2024.e24638

Mingming Li*, Eugeny Kolpak, Pavel Zhukov, Gurgen Gukasyan, and Patricio Federico Lewis Zuñiga. 2023. “China’s Current Energy Policy: Dependencies and Contradictions.” *Polish Journal of Environmental Studies* 32(4), 3663–3672. doi.org/10.15244/pjoes/163564

Pengfei Guo*, Xinyun Hu*, Shikuan Zhao, and **Mingming Li**. 2023. “The growth impact of infrastructure capital investment: the role of regional innovation capacity—evidence from China.” *Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja* 36(2), 2142632. doi.org/10.1080/1331677x.2022.2142632

Fang Su, **Mingming Li***, A. Shanthini, and R. Parthasarathy. 2021. “Systematic effective modeling and geospatial information framework for environmental issues in urban areas.” *Environmental Impact Assessment Review* 86, 106507. doi.org/10.1016/j.eiar.2020.106507

Xinyun Hu and **Mingming Li***. 2020. “Ecopolitical discourse: Authoritarianism or democracy? — Evidence from China.” *PLOS ONE* 15(10), e0239872. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0239872

Zhigao Luo*, Xinyun Hu, **Mingming Li**, Jirui Yang, and Chuanhao Wen. 2019. “Centralization or Decentralization of Environmental Governance—Evidence from China.” *Sustainability* 11(24), 6938. doi.org/10.3390/su11246938

Additional Research

Jiangbo Li, Jun Cheng*, and **Mingming Li**. 2026. “Educational Authority in Digitally Mediated Filipino Transnational Families: Smartphones, Parenting, and Children's Learning Across Households.” *Family Relations*. Advance online publication. doi.org/10.1111/fare.70346

Mingming Li, Nuo Xu, and Yue Liang*. 2026. “Social Reality as a Phenomenological Construct: Understanding Intersubjectivity through the Lens of Shared Meaning.” *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science* 60(1), 17. doi.org/10.1007/s12124-026-09987-y

Nasi Wang and **Mingming Li***. 2026. “Teachers’ perceptions of the risks and benefits of AI in higher education: A case study of ERNIE Bot.” *Innovations in Education and Teaching International* 63(1), 318–330. doi.org/10.1080/14703297.2024.2432429

Xiaolong Shen, Jiangbo Li, **Mingming Li**, and Amir Karimi*. 2025. “A 29-Year (1994–2023) Bibliometrics Analysis of Usage of the Gamification in History Education.” *European Journal of Education* 60(4), e70256. doi.org/10.1111/ejed.70256

Mingming Li* and Xinxin Xu. 2022. “Fertility Intentions for a Second Child and Their Influencing Factors in Contemporary China.” *Frontiers in Psychology* 13, 883317. doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.883317

Jun Cheng, **Mingming Li**, and Qinya Weng*. “A Multidimensional Measure of Psychological Traits Underlying Learning: Development and Validation.” Submitted after major revision, *BMC Psychology*.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Mingming Li and Xinxin Ma. “Employment Protection and Within-Couple Wage Inequality in China.” In *Female Employment and Gender Inequality: Comparative Evidence from East Asia*, edited by Xinxin Ma and Yang Du. Springer. Invited chapter in preparation; volume under contract, with publication expected in June 2027.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Central European University
Department of Economics and Business

Labor Economics (MA in Economics)	04/2021–06/2021
Trading and Portfolio Theory (MS in Finance)	09/2020–01/2021; 09/2021–12/2021
Asset Pricing (MS in Finance)	01/2021–04/2021
Investments I and II (MS in Finance)	09/2019–12/2019

School of Public Policy

Economic Analysis for Public Policy	09/2019–12/2019

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Global GLO–JOPE Conference, Bonn, Germany (forthcoming)	11/2026–12/2026
Sociology Colloquium, University of Innsbruck, Austria	10/2026
121st Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York, USA	08/2026
International Gender & STEM Network Conference, Salzburg, Austria	07/2026
Economy, Politics & Society Summer Summit, Innsbruck, Austria	04/2026
10th International NEPS Conference, LIfBi, Bamberg, Germany	12/2025
LIfBi Colloquium, Bamberg, Germany	12/2025
16th European Sociological Association Conference, Porto, Portugal	08/2024
Ring-Seminar on Education, Family and Employment over the Life-Course, Trento, Italy	12/2023

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Academic Editor, PLOS ONE 01/2024–01/2025

Sociology; economics; gender studies.

Ad hoc reviewer for journals Applied Economics; Applied Economics Letters; Asia Pacific Education Review; BMC Geriatrics; BMC Health Services Research; BMC Medical Education; BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth; BMC Primary Care; BMC Psychology; BMC Public Health; Case Studies on Transport Policy; China & World Economy; Clean Technologies and Environmental Policy; Cogent Economics & Finance; Cogent Education; Economic Analysis and Policy; Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja; Education Sciences; Energy Sources, Part B: Economics, Planning, and Policy; Environmental Geochemistry and Health; Environmental Monitoring and Assessment; Environmental Sciences Europe; Frontiers in Public Health; Global Environmental Change; Health Economics Review; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; International Journal for Equity in Health; International Review of Economics & Finance; International Social Science Journal; Journal of Asian Economics; Journal of Infrastructure, Policy and Development; Journal of the Asia Pacific Economy; Labour and Industry; Marriage & Family Review; Mathematical Population Studies; PLOS ONE; Post-Communist Economies; SAGE Open; Scientific Reports; Social Sciences & Humanities Open; Studies in Higher Education; Sustainability; Telecommunications Policy.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

CEU Doctoral Scholarship 09/2018–09/2021

Stipendium Hungaricum Scholarship 09/2016–09/2018

SKILLS

Research software Stata (proficient); Python, MATLAB, and SPSS (intermediate).

Office and typesetting Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint (proficient); LaTeX (intermediate).

Languages Chinese (native); English (proficient); German (basic conversational).